and technology and linkages between Indian and Russian universities were revived.

The broader geopolitical landscape

The India–Russia relationship has inevitably been impacted by the course of India's relations with the US and China, the deterioration of Russia–US relations, and the intensification of the Russia–China engagement.

Alongside the rejuvenation of India–Russia relations in the early 2000s was a resurgence of India–US relations. Indian Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee and US President George W Bush drew up a roadmap for an India–US strategic partnership, which eventually led to the India–US civil nuclear agreement (2008) and the pivotal US role in getting the NSG to open up civil nuclear cooperation with India. The United States saw attractive opportunities in India's expanding market, its huge defence imports, and its ambitious nuclear power generation plans. From a strategic perspective, conscious of the increasing challenge from China to its position as the global hegemon, the United States saw value in partnering with a strong, democratic India in this region.[12] For India, this partnership with the sole superpower opened the door to US technologies and investments. The opportunity to import sophisticated US defence equipment matched India's desire to diversify its defence acquisitions, hitherto virtually limited to Russia. The partnership included cooperation with the United States in supporting democracy and economic reconstruction in Afghanistan. Finally, India supported the premise on which the United States sought to enhance India's military power in its region.[13] Like the United States, India was careful not to project the partnership in terms of "balancing" China.